

All figures sourced from Government of Canada and Government of Alberta open data, Statistics Canada, federal and provincial statute, UN treaty, and peer-reviewed research.

Section 4.2 — The Covenant: We See You

The Indigenous Disability in Alberta report, published April 2026, closed with a single covenant. The covenant was not a policy proposal. It was a recognition. It was the refusal to allow the architecture to treat the people inside it as administrative categories, caseload counts, or budget-line entries.

This document extends that covenant explicitly to seniors and disabled people across the architecture documented in the preceding 98 pages. The covenant is the same. The population it names is wider.

To the worker whose body has failed

The cascade documented in Movement One is your daily life, or it will be. The mechanisms are published. The capture is documented. The wait is documented. The appeal that no longer exists is documented. The 79,290 figure includes you, or will include you, or includes someone you love.

The cage that this document names is the architecture you are inside. The architecture was not designed against your specific case; it was designed against the case of every recipient. You are not the failure. The architecture's structural pattern is the failure. The documentation is what shows the pattern.

You are not invisible. We see you.

To the senior who has reached 65

The architecture documented in Movement Two is what your monthly income depends on. The published Service Canada amounts are what you receive. The published Government of Alberta amounts are what your provincial supplement is. The partnership penalty calculated against the published GIS table is what you absorb for being together rather than apart. The 6,000 to 8,000 figure includes you, or will include you, or includes someone you know, when the July 1, 2026 threshold cut takes effect.

You paid in. The architecture did not return what your intuition predicted it would return. The eight-layer structural answer documented in Section 2.8 is the answer. The answer is not your fault. You navigated the architecture the architecture required you to navigate, on the schedule the architecture required, with the documentation the architecture demanded. The result was determined by the formula.

You are not invisible. We see you.

To the Indigenous Albertan

The 19.07-year mortality gap documented in 2023 is the cumulative biological outcome of conditions documented across the campaign's *Indigenous Disability in Alberta* report. The gap is not nature. The gap is not chance. The gap is the result of policy choices that have been documented, named, and challenged across centuries by Indigenous-led advocacy, by federal commissions, by provincial inquiries, by the Truth and Reconciliation Commission, by the United Nations Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples, by the Calls to Action that this document's Section 3.1 references and that the existing campaign report Sections 12-14 detail.

The senior architecture is, for the average First Nations Albertan, an architecture that does not arrive in time. The cohort whose names are not in the senior-program databases — who died before reaching them — is the cohort whose absence is the most direct evidence of the failure. The cohort that does survive to access the senior architecture navigates it with the additional pressures Section 3.1 documents.

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You are not invisible. We see you.

To the 2SLGBTQ+ senior

The decriminalization cohort documented in Section 3.2 is your cohort. The criminalization period was your childhood and the early decades of your adult life. Common-law recognition was 2000. Marriage was 2005. The benefit-calculation history is shorter than your relationship history.

The family-of-choice that has, for decades, served as your functional family is not recognized in the federal-or-provincial benefit calculation. The contribution history that lawful workplace discrimination suppressed during your working years is the contribution history the CPP formula now operates on. The "back into the closet" question at long-term care entry is the question the architecture leaves you to navigate.

You are not invisible. We see you.

To the immigrant senior under 20-year sponsorship

The October 1, 2025 sponsorship-rule extension means that, if you arrived in Canada under parent-and-grandparent sponsorship after the 2014 IRPR amendments, you are now waiting until 2036 — twenty years from your landing date — for eligibility for the Guaranteed Income Supplement, the Allowance, and the Allowance for the Survivor. You are eligible for the basic Old Age Security pension at the partial rate, after meeting the 10-year residency requirement. The supplement that lifts the partial OAS to a survivable monthly income is not available to you for the second decade of your Canadian residency.

Your sponsor is bearing the financial responsibility. Your sponsor's circumstances may not remain stable across 20 years. The protective provisions for sponsorship breakdown exist; the provisions require active claim-making at the moment of breakdown. The architecture has been designed in a way that, in operational reality, structurally extends adult-child financial responsibility for sponsored seniors for two decades.

You are not invisible. We see you.

To the disabled adult caregiving for an aging parent

The bidirectional dependency configuration documented in Section 3.4 is yours. You are an AISH or ADAP recipient. You are managing your own qualifying conditions. You are also providing care to a parent whose own aging-related needs have evolved across the years.

The household-income calculation under the cohabitation rule treats your parent's income or contribution as part of the assessment. The architecture does not credit you for the care you provide. The succession question — what happens at your parent's death, what happens to your parent's home if any inheritance occurs, what happens to the household configuration that has structured your life — is the question the asset cap and the AISH benefit framework do not adequately address.

You are not invisible. We see you.

To the parent-caregiver who is entering long-term care

You have provided primary care to your disabled adult son or daughter for decades. Your own health now requires LTC entry. The disabled adult you have been caring for does not change. The formal supports that

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the architecture provides through PDD or AISH or ADAP do not adequately replace what you have been providing, because the formal supports were never adequate; you have been making up the difference.

The transition you are facing is the transition the architecture does not have a structure to manage. The disabled adult you love will need formal support that the architecture is, in current operational reality, not configured to provide at scale. The advocacy community knows this. The campaign that publishes this document knows this. The provincial government has been informed of this and has not, as of the date of this document, restructured the architecture to address it.

You are not invisible. We see you.

To the family caregiver whose unpaid labour is the architecture's hidden foundation

The \$97 to \$130 billion in annual economic value that the Canadian Centre for Caregiving Excellence has estimated for unpaid Canadian caregiving labour is your contribution. The architecture relies on you. The architecture does not pay you. The architecture's modest tax credits — the federal Canada Caregiver Credit, the Alberta Caregiver Credit being consolidated under the 2026 provincial budget — do not approach the value of the labour you provide.

Your own employment, retirement savings, mental health, and physical health bear the cost of the labour. The cost is documented in research literature spanning four decades. The architecture has not adopted the research-documented frameworks of caregiver compensation that other jurisdictions employ. The architecture has, instead, continued to rely on you while not formally recognizing you.

You are not invisible. We see you.

To everyone the document has not named individually

The covenant is for everyone the architecture documented across these 98 pages affects. The senior in private rental housing watching annual rent increases on a fixed federal income. The senior in continuing care managing on \$373 per month of disposable income after accommodation charges. The senior who deferred OAS not knowing the deferral would disqualify them from Alberta's provincial supplements. The disabled adult who was approved for AISH in 2023 and is now facing the Bill 12 reassessment process. The grandmother in continuing care who lost her right to call her own caseworker when the call centre replaced individual caseworkers in 2024-25.

Each is a person. The architecture is the architecture each is inside. The documentation is what names the architecture as it operates.

You are not invisible. We see you.

What the covenant requires

The covenant is not a policy proposal. The campaign that publishes this document has separate policy submissions that articulate the specific reforms the campaign is asking the federal and provincial governments to enact. Those submissions are part of the public record and are referenced in the source index that closes this document.

The covenant is a recognition. The recognition is that the people inside the architecture are not, in the operational reality of their lives, administrative categories. They are people. The architecture's tendency to

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treat them as categories is the structural pattern this document has documented across 19 sections and across 98 pages of primary-source-grounded analysis.

The recognition has operational consequences. It requires that the documentation exist, that the documentation be accessible, that the documentation be in a form that the people inside the architecture can use to understand what they are encountering. The campaign's 32-episode audio library, the 19 standalone Community Edition PDFs, the existing *Indigenous Disability in Alberta* and *AISH Evidentiary Report Series* and *Compound Failure Brief* and *Charter Constitutional Analysis* and the broader campaign canon — and now this document — are the operational form the recognition takes.

The recognition also requires that the policy advocacy continue. The federal submission to HUMA in April 2026 documenting the Canada Disability Benefit clawback is part of the recognition. The municipal coalition documented in the campaign's Coalition and UN CRPD Addendum — Calgary, Edmonton, Lethbridge, Camrose, Red Deer, Claresholm, Medicine Hat — calling for the AISH-to-ADAP transition to be paused pending meaningful consultation, is part of the recognition. The Inclusion Alberta media releases on Bill 12, the Public Interest Alberta budget analyses, the AUPE caseworker statements, and the broader advocacy pressure are part of the recognition.

The recognition does not depend on the federal or provincial government accepting it. The recognition exists because the population it names exists, and because the documentation that names the population is in the public record. The architecture is what it is. The documentation is what it is. The covenant is what it is.

The closing line

The cage doesn't end when you turn 65. It changes shape.

The architecture documented across this document is the cage. The shape it changes into at age 65 is the federal-and-provincial senior architecture documented in Movement Two. The shape it takes for the populations documented in Movement Three is the architecture plus the additional structural pressures specific to those populations. The shape it takes for the worker traced through Movement One is the cascade from workplace injury through long-term care.

The cage is documented. The mechanisms are published. The dollar amounts are sourced to Government of Canada and Government of Alberta records. The political history is on the legislative record. The capture mechanisms are in the program rules. The population the cage operates against is approximately 79,290 disabled Albertans plus the broader Canadian senior population in 2026, and the cohort approaching senior years across the next four decades.

The cage does not end. It changes shape.

We see you. You are not invisible.

The Source Index follows.